

Socioeconomic Disparities Between The Immigrant and Non-Immigrant Communities of Suffolk County

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BACKGROUND AND PURPOSE

- Suffolk County is a microcosm of complex immigrant integration within the United States, reflecting economic, social, and cultural dynamics.
- Immigration from Europe, Asia, Latin America, and recent influxes from Central America and the Caribbean have reshaped the County's demographics.
- Even with a rich integration history, restrictive covenants, redlining, and zoning laws persisted leading to disparities.
- There is a pressing need to explore these disparities, therefore the purpose of this study was to explore the existing resources in two towns of Suffolk County New York.

OBJECTIVES

- To identify the general demographics in Brentwood and East Islip towns.
- To assess and visualize the food pantries and SNAP programs in Brentwood and East Islip.
- To assess and visualize access to health centers in Brentwood and East Islip.
- To identify shelter homes in Brentwood and East Islip
- To assess and visualize access to public transportation in Brentwood and East Islip

METHODS

- The socioeconomic disparities in the towns of East Islip and Brentwood, along with different variables were explored.
- Demographic data including total population, household income, educational qualification, and race using information from census.gov
- Food pantries & SNAP programs, health centers, public transportation, and shelter homes available in both towns were investigated.
- Geo Mapping on Quantum Geographic Information System (QGIS) was used to visualize the distribution of selected variables in both towns of Suffolk County.

Figure 1 : Population Demographics by Race in Brentwood and East Islip

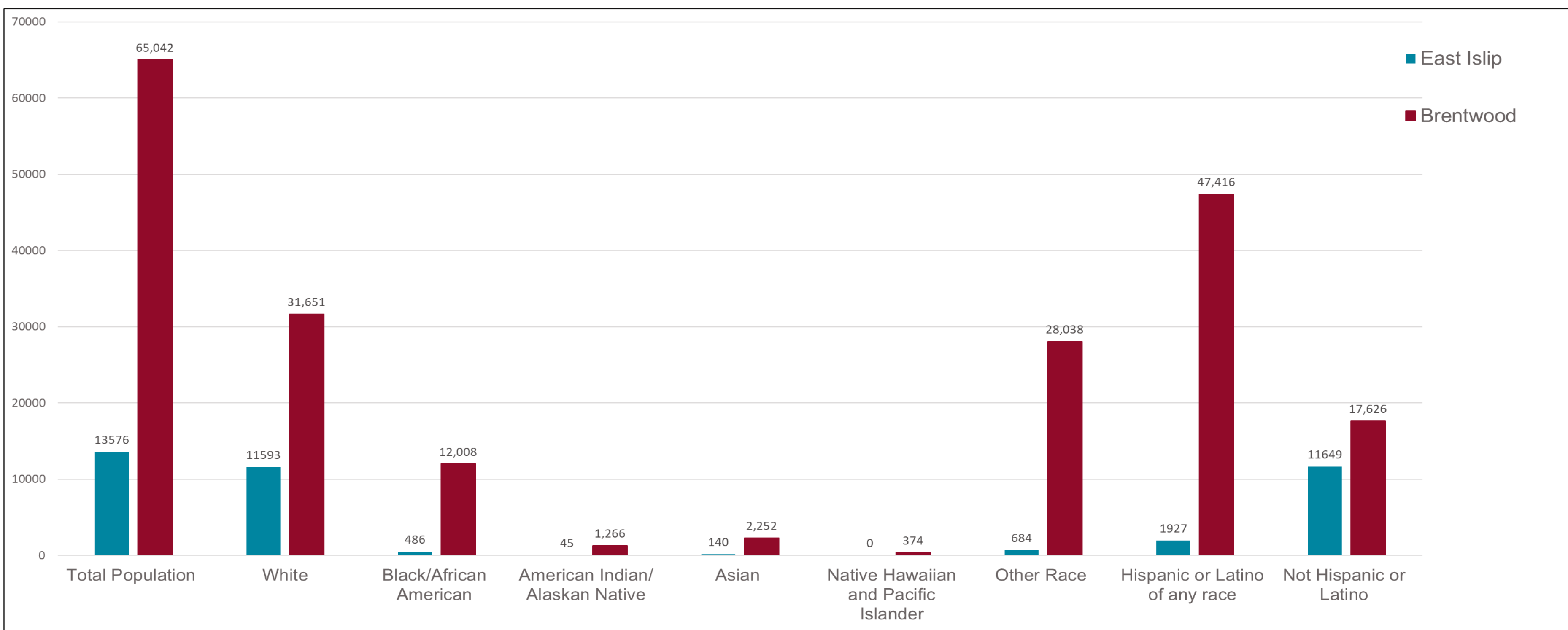


Figure 2:Food Pantries and SNAP Retailers in Brentwood and East Islip

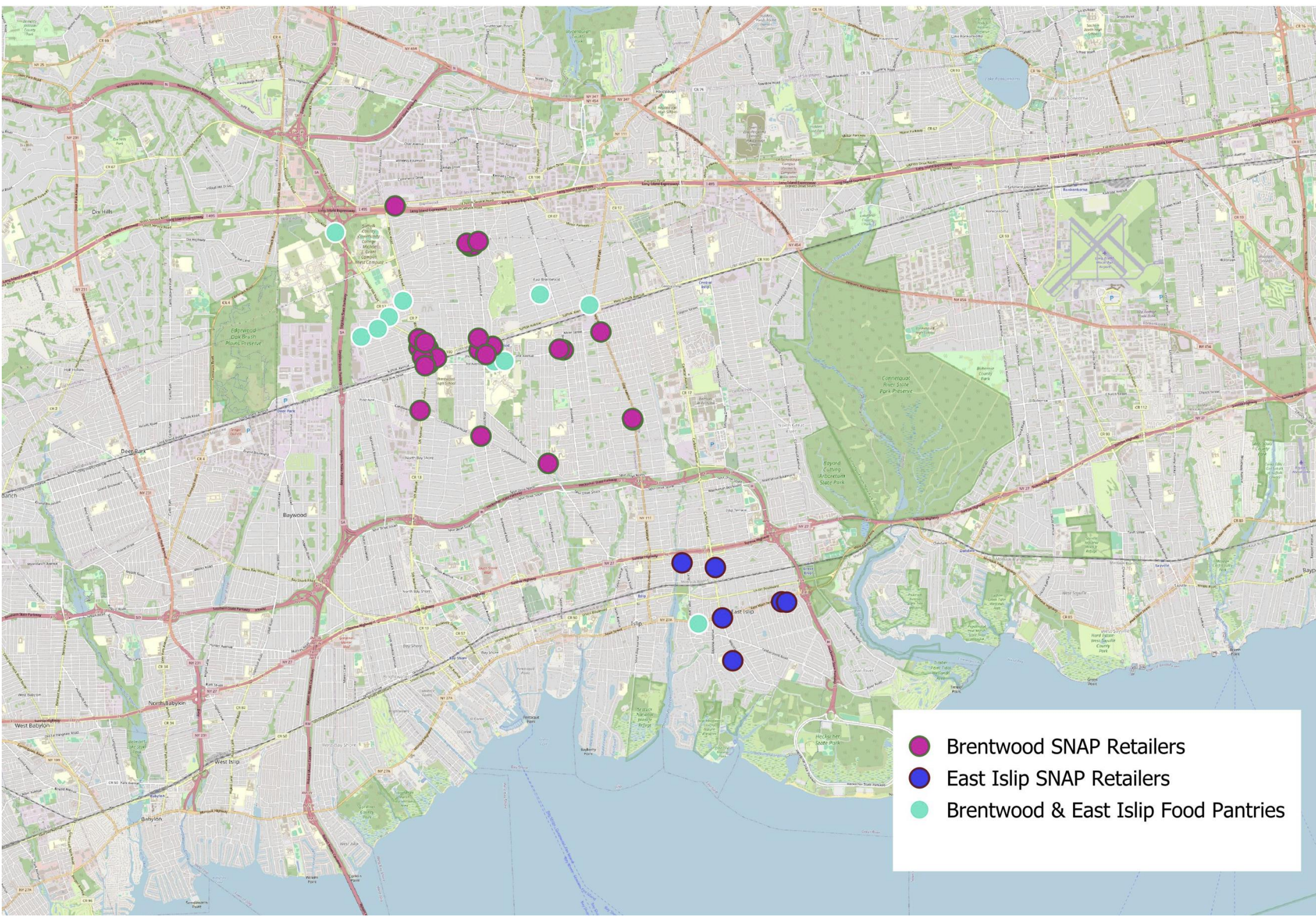
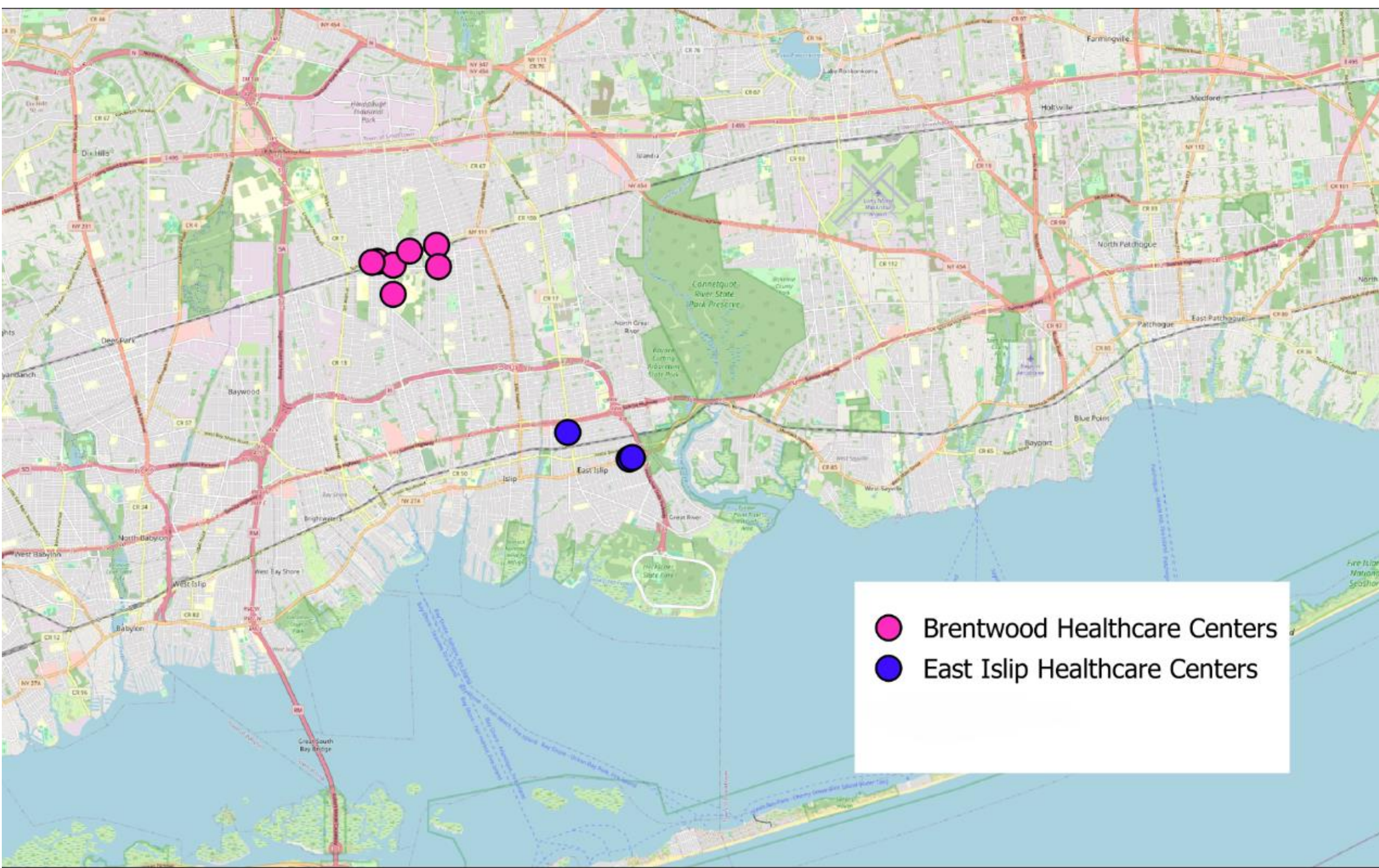


Figure 3: Health centers in Brentwood and East Islip



RESULTS

- Poverty Rate and Median Household Income:** A perfect negative correlation (-1.0), indicated that as the median household income decreased, there was an increase in the poverty rate.
- Poverty Rate with Total Enrollment and Total ELL (English Language Learners):** Both showed a perfect positive correlation (1.0). This correlation may stem from demographic factors like younger populations and higher birth rates in lower-income areas.
- Travel Time:** The travel times were consistent, with a standard deviation of just 1.225 minutes. This small variation implies a reliable transportation schedule and minimal change in travel time. However, travel time is longer due to multiple transfers.
- Shelter Homes:** Brentwood, with a high immigrant population, low income, and limited transportation, has only two shelter homes within the town.
- Food Pantries and SNAP Retailers:** Brentwood has more food pantries and people living here depend more on the SNAP benefits as compared to East Islip

RECOMMENDATIONS

- Economic Aid:** Boost SNAP assistance in Brentwood for the 2,028 reliant households and increase local SNAP retailers.
- Education Outreach:** In response to high ELL rates tied to poverty, implement focused ESL programs for Brentwood's youth.
- Healthcare Provision:** Double healthcare facilities in Brentwood to meet the needs of its low-income population.
- Transport Solutions:** Improve public transit for the 39% in Brentwood lacking private vehicles, thus ensuring access to food and health services.
- Shelter Homes:** Add shelters in Brentwood to serve the homeless, considering the town's existing facilities and income challenges.